

Participant: 1, CS student, on-site, MacBook.

Tasks:

1. Define optimisation scenarios and required parameters.
2. Check the solution provided and go through the evaluation process.
3. Be able to read and understand the results page.

Test record:

The participant chose buying a house as the optimisation scenario. The design parameters include the distance between the house and the city centre, the distance between the house and the station, and the size of the house. The objectives include the house price (minimise) and appreciation potential of the house(maximise).

One test took about 9 minutes

Problems and questions:

- The participant did not have a clear understanding of the web page at the beginning and did not completely get the meaning of optimization.
- The participant did not know the filled-in example parameters on the “Define” page were editable in the first place, thinking those were only examples.
- Didn't understand the meaning of the button "I want to refine this" and also did not completely understand how it is differentiated from the button "Give me the next one"
- Despite the prompt, the participant didn't realize that had to evaluate at least three options.
- Didn't understand by what criteria options on the result page were generated.
- Feel the application looks better if the window is displayed in the centre of the page.

Inspiration for future tests:

Whether the selection criteria of the participants need to be considered?

A clearer context introduction shall be given at the beginning.

Consider displaying a complete demonstration of the optimization process at the beginning.